

OCCUPATIONAL ENGLISH TEST

WRITING SUB-TEST: MEDICINE

TIME ALLOWED: **READING TIME: 5 MINUTES**
WRITING TIME: 40 MINUTES

Read the case notes below and complete the writing task which follows.

Notes:

Mrs Mary Clarke (born on 17 September 1960) is a patient in your General Practice.

Patient details

Name: Mrs Mary Clarke

Address: 26 Marine Drive
Riverside

Social background:

54-year-old office clerk
Married, lives at home with husband and 20-year-old son
Smokes 30-35 cigarettes per day (>30 yrs)

Family/medical history:

Mother died 66 y.o. – laryngeal carcinoma
Father (coal miner) died 54 y.o. – mining-related lung disease
Nil medication
No known allergies

04.07.15 Patient presented with sore throat, body aches, fever and cough.

Prescription: Augmentin (penicillin)

22.08.15

Presenting complaint:

7-week Hx of dry non-productive cough (no haemoptysis)
Cough commenced with flu-like symptoms → cleared with Augmentin
Associated mild shortness of breath (esp. at night) and "strange sensation of heaviness" in chest
Nil fever, night sweats or rigors
Exercise tolerance OK – chores, shopping, could walk up 2 sets of stairs

Examination: T: 36.7°C, P: 80 regular, Ht: 165cm, Wt: 68kg

Respiratory exam – signs of consolidation associated with monophonic wheeze in R mid-zone
No cyanosis/dyspnoea/ascites
No hoarse voice/Horner's syndrome
No cervical lymphadenopathy
No hepatosplenomegaly/bone pain
Systems review – GIT & CV normal
Sputum cytology – normal
Chest X-ray and CT – R middle lobe atelectasis, enlarged R hilum

Assessment: ?Bronchogenic carcinoma

Plan: Counselling on potential diagnosis and need for further investigations
Refer to thoracic surgeon for follow-up investigations (bronchoscopy, biopsy) and assessment

Writing Task:

Using the information given in the case notes, write a letter of referral to the thoracic surgeon, Dr Penny Clifton, seeking follow-up investigations and assessment. Address the letter to: Dr Penny Clifton, Department of Cardiothoracic Surgery, Central Hospital, Main Street, Stillwater.

In your answer:

- **Expand the relevant notes into complete sentences**
- **Do not use note form**
- **Use letter format**

The body of the letter should be approximately 180–200 words.